

BUYERS' GUIDE

ESTYLE

How To Select THE SMARTEST SMART TV In The Market



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After a long day's work, the best way to relax is probably to watch the latest blockbuster, at home. Yes, the movie-watching experience at home has transformed with TVs having gigantic screens, crystal-clear displays and terrific sound quality. With smart TVs, you can connect your TV to a Wi-Fi network, download the latest episodes of your favourite show and watch content that is stored on your mobile phone, on the big screen. But how do you decide which smart TV to invest in? This guide will help you choose the right one for your home.

Features to watch out for

Before we go ahead and show you our list of recommended smart TVs, let us under-

stand the important features of these devices and how these play out as you begin to use these. This will enable you to compare and review TVs even outside our recommendations list, and help you make the right choice.

One of the main features of smart TVs is that these have software platforms, just like PCs and mobile phones. Let us take a look at each of these.

Android TV. This is one of the most popular platforms and gives you the freedom to access Google Play store from your TV, to purchase apps and games. Different manufacturers tie up with different platforms but Sony Android TVs are popular. You can also control these TVs using TV SideView app that features

voice search. Google Cast allows media to be streamed to the TV, while gaming controllers from Logitech and Razer let you have fun with console-less gaming. The best thing about this one is the collection of apps.

Firefox OS. This is the one you will see with most Panasonic TVs. It has been refreshed for 2016 with a new design that looks much better than the previous version. It also comes with a barebones version of Firefox browser. The lack of Google's Play store means it does not have as much content but it still wins on the interface design side. The simple design is the winner for this one.

Smart hub (Tizen). This comes with Samsung TVs and is based on their Tizen operating system (OS). It is decently customisable and does not clutter up much. However, there are

Other features

Connectivity. Smart TVs usually connect to the Internet using a Wi-Fi network. Sometimes, these may also have an Ethernet port for wired Internet connectivity. Check which mode of connectivity the TV is equipped with to ensure that it is suitable for your home.

The 3D experience. Many TV companies have advertised this feature in the past few years. Coupled with 3D glasses, it promises to change your viewing experience completely. However, movies and TV shows first need to be modified to make these suitable for 3D TVs. Do keep in mind the fact that 3D content for TVs is limited.

Screen size. TV screen sizes are measured using the diagonal length of the screen. However, depending on the screen aspect ratio (for example, 4:3 or 16:9), the same diagonal length will refer to different screen areas. Most TVs in the market have 16:9 aspect ratio, which refers to the ratio between the width and height of the screen. Choose the right screen size according to where you plan to install your TV, and how far you will be seated from it. This will ensure a comfortable viewing experience.

Resolution. This is probably the most important feature of a television, as it ensures that images displayed on the screen are clear. It is important to ensure that the screen resolution is good, otherwise you may have a TV with a giant screen but poor image quality. One of the best screen resolutions currently available is 4K or ultra high-definition (UHD), which refers to a resolution of 3840x2160 pixels. Other resolutions include 1080p (1920x1080 pixels) and WUXGA (1920x1200 pixels).

Viewing angle. This refers to the angle up to which you can view images clearly on the TV before image quality drops. A higher value of viewing angle would be preferable because it ensures that image colour quality does not get altered when viewed from the side.

Speakers. Sound quality is also an important characteristic of a TV. To ensure that your overall TV watching experience is of high quality, opt for a TV with a good sound system. Speaker sound is expressed in watts (W). This corresponds to a specific decibel (dB) value. 16W corresponds to 102dB and 32W corresponds to 105dB. Most TVs have a speaker output of 14W to 20W.